What the town knows

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming massacre, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.

TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to four of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays a point. Be wrong and it costs you half of one.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

A WORD TO THE SURVIVORS

If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it. Nobody can tell by looking. Keep a straight face. Everyone’s objectives are released at the start of the game, and the survivors find out who they are at the same moment.

THE BLACK VEIL

The rules of the night

1. Your card has three tabs. Public is what everyone knows. Background is your history and the people you know. Private is yours alone: your secrets, your five objectives, and anything you must not say aloud.
2. At eight o'clock every card opens at once. From then on the room is a cocktail party. Mingle, trade, bargain. Each objective is worth one point.
3. Later in the evening a body will be found. There is no town hall and no host to rule on anything. Question whom you like. Nobody is forced to answer.
4. Nothing is ever taken from anyone. Props change hands by a deal, and nobody brings anything: whatever you carry is handed to you at the door. Hidden game pieces are only in shared rooms, never in bedrooms, bathrooms, closets or drawers.
5. Some objectives happen in the room, not on your phone: you do them for real, tap Claim, then go to Bartend Joe at the bar, who gives you an approval word to type once he is satisfied it happened.
6. You start with House bills ($100 each). Some clues cost a bill: a line tagged "Costs $100 at the bar" is told only after you drop a $100 bill in the House Tin. Your own small secret can be sold to another guest, for $200. At the end, count your bills: the quarter of the room that ends the night best off against where they started (the most gained, or the least spent) earns an extra point.
7. Walk, do not run, and keep your drink in your hand.
8. Type your answers into your phone whenever you like, and as often as you like. Only your last answer to each question counts. The site will not tell you whether you were right; nobody will, until the end.
9. Points come from your five objectives (5), the survivors you name (up to 4), and above all the three mysteries: the Old, the New and the Connection (10). Each group races for one extra point, and the best-off quarter of the room earns one more. Finish every objective and never work out the story and you cannot win.

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